

WORKSHOP · SESSION 1

OAuth 2.0 — the real flow, in Go

Learn OAuth by running a real go-oidc demo end to end.

RUN THE LAB

```
cd resource/labs/day1-go-oauth-demo  
go run .  
open http://localhost:8082
```

Auth Code + PKCE

Refresh Token

Client Credentials

Device Authorization

Explain the flow without hiding behind JWT

- 1 Map the four OAuth actors and the endpoints onto the running app.
- 2 Draw Authorization Code + PKCE from memory.
- 3 Explain browser / front-channel vs back-channel requests.
- 4 Explain state, redirect_uri, code_challenge, and code_verifier.
- 5 Choose the right flow for common application shapes.

One Go program, three separate servers

Real network separation — each OAuth role is its own HTTP server (see main.go).

Authorization Server

:8080 · op.go

go-oidc OpenID Provider
/authorize /token
/introspect
/device_authorization

Resource Server API

:8081 · api.go

Protected endpoints
/api/profile
/api/fraud-report
/api/deploy

Client App

:8082 · client.go

RepoBoard + service + CLI
/start /callback
/refresh /call-api
START HERE → :8082

How we teach each flow

Concept

What problem are we solving?

Diagram

Who talks to whom, and on which channel?

Go code

Which function in client.go / op.go / api.go?

Browser flow

What URL or token actually appears?

Checkpoint

Can participants explain it back?

Participants run and read the demo — they do not write code in Session 1.

Limited access without the password

RepoBoard needs to read the user's GitHub-like profile — without ever getting their password.

Password sharing — wrong shape

- User hands RepoBoard a password
- App can do everything the user can
- No way to scope to one resource
- Revoking means changing the password

OAuth delegation — right shape

- User approves limited API access
- Client receives a scoped token, not a password
- Access can be revoked on its own
- Token expires automatically

The client receives permission, not the user's password.

Map the four actors onto the code

Resource Owner

Mock user “Alya Developer” (Subject = alya)

Client

:8082 · client.go — RepoBoard (client_id repoboard-web)

Authorization Server

:8080 · op.go — go-oidc provider (login, consent, tokens)

Resource Server

:8081 · api.go — protected APIs, validates tokens

Ask the room: which actor issues the token, and which actor validates it?

/authorize and /token are not interchangeable

/authorize (:8080, front-channel)

- Browser redirect — the user sees it
- Login + consent happen here
- Returns: code + state in the redirect

/token (:8080, back-channel)

- Server-to-server POST — no redirect
- Exchanges code (+ verifier) for tokens
- Returns: JSON token response

Both endpoints are served by go-oidc (`op.Handler()`) — you do not implement them. Your client calls them from client.go.

The browser gets a code; the client gets tokens

- 1 **Client** `/start (:8082)`
- 2 **Authorize** `/authorize (:8080)`
- 3 **Callback** `/callback?code&state (:8082)`
- 4 **Token** `POST /token (:8080)`
- 5 **API** `GET /api/profile (:8081)`

Demo anchor

Click “Start Auth Code + PKCE flow” on :8082, then ask participants what travels through the browser vs the back-channel.

Client builds the request before redirecting

client.go

```
func (c *ClientApp) StartAuthCode(w, r) {
    state          := randomString(18)
    codeVerifier   := randomString(48)
    codeChallenge  := pkceChallenge(codeVerifier)
    // save state + verifier in the session

    q := url.Values{}
    q.Set("response_type", "code")
    q.Set("client_id", "repoboard-web")
    q.Set("redirect_uri", clientBaseURL+"/callback")
    q.Set("scope", "openid profile profile.read offline_access")
    q.Set("state", state)
    q.Set("code_challenge", codeChallenge)
    q.Set("code_challenge_method", "S256")
    http.Redirect(w, r, opBaseURL+"/authorize?" + q.Encode(), 302)
}
```

What to point at

- state + code_verifier are created on the client, before any redirect.
- Only the code_challenge (a hash) goes through the browser.
- The verifier stays in the session — it is never sent to /authorize.

Every parameter in the redirect, explained

response_type=code	Ask for an authorization code
client_id	Identify the client app (repoboard-web)
redirect_uri	Where the browser returns (:8082/callback)
scope	Permissions requested
state	Callback binding — CSRF protection
code_challenge (+ _method=S256)	PKCE challenge for the code exchange

Login & consent is a go-oidc policy

op.go

```
loginPolicy := gooidc.NewPolicy("simple_login",
    func(...) bool { return true }, // applies to all
    func(w, r, as, _) (gooidc.Status, error) {
        if r.Method == GET {
            // render the consent screen
            return gooidc.StatusPending, nil
        }
        if r.FormValue("approve") == "true" {
            as.Subject = "alya"
            as.GrantedScopes = as.Scopes
            return gooidc.StatusSuccess, nil
        }
        return gooidc.StatusFailure, nil
    })
```

What to point at

- This is the hook where a real app would check username / password / MFA.
- go-oidc creates and stores the authorization code internally on success.
- The code is short-lived and is not an access token.

Verify state, then exchange the code

client.go

```
func (c *ClientApp) Callback(w, r) {
    code := r.URL.Query().Get("code")
    state := r.URL.Query().Get("state")
    if state == "" || state != expectedState {
        http.Error(w, "state mismatch – possible CSRF", 400)
        return
    }
    // back-channel POST to /token
    postForm(opBaseURL+"/token", url.Values{
        "grant_type": {"authorization_code"},
        "client_id": {"repoboard-web"},
        "code": {"code"},
        "redirect_uri": {clientBaseURL + "/callback"},
        "code_verifier": {codeVerifier},
    })
}
```

What to point at

- The callback arrives through the browser (front-channel).
- state is checked first — reject anything the client did not start.
- The code-for-token exchange is back-channel, and carries the code_verifier.

go-oidc verifies the exchange for you

At /token, go-oidc checks:

- The code exists and has not been used
- client_id and redirect_uri match the original request
- SHA-256(code_verifier) equals the stored code_challenge
- Then it issues access + refresh tokens

op.go

```
// enabled by provider options in op.go  
provider.WithAuthCodeGrant(store, ResponseTypeCode),  
provider.WithPKCE(CodeChallengeMethodSHA256),  
provider.WithRefreshTokenGrant(store),  
provider.WithRefreshTokenRotation(),
```

Your client never implements PKCE verification — it is a configuration choice on the server.

It binds the exchange to the original request

At /authorize

go-oidc stores client_id, redirect_uri, scope, state, code_challenge.

At /callback

The browser returns code + state to the client.

At /token

The client resends redirect_uri + code_verifier; go-oidc checks they match.

The token endpoint does not redirect — it verifies the exchange belongs to the same request.

Challenge first, verifier later

Before redirect (client)

- Create code_verifier (random secret)
- Send code_challenge = hash of verifier

At /token (client → server)

- Client sends the code_verifier
- Server hashes it and compares

```
code_challenge = BASE64URL( SHA256(code_verifier) )    // pkceChallenge() in client.go
```

SHA-256 is one-way: the server repeats the hash and compares — it never reverses it.

The resource server validates by introspection

api.go

```
func apiProfile(w, r) {  
    info, ok := introspect(r, "profile.read")  
    if !ok {  
        writeJSON(w, 401, ...) // invalid token or scope  
        return  
    }  
    // return profile JSON  
}  
  
// introspect(): POST /introspect (Basic auth),  
// require active == true AND the needed scope
```

What to point at

- The API (:8081) does not share memory with the AS (:8080).
- It validates the bearer token by calling /introspect — the real decoupled pattern.
- A token for the wrong API or missing scope is rejected.

Renew access without re-authorizing

How the demo does it

- client.go Refresh() posts grant_type=refresh_token
- Rotation is on: a new refresh token replaces the old one
- Refresh tokens are issued only when offline_access scope is granted

Why it matters

- Access tokens should be short-lived
- Refresh tokens are more sensitive — they mint new access tokens
- Rotation makes refresh-token reuse detectable

Service-to-service — no user, no browser

How the demo does it

- order-service authenticates with Basic auth (id : secret)
- grant_type=client_credentials, scope fraud.check
- Then calls /api/fraud-report with the token

Key idea

- No browser redirect, no consent screen
- The token represents the service itself, not a user
- A confidential client can safely hold a secret

Approve on a second device while the CLI polls

How the demo does it

- DeviceStart() → POST /device_authorization (deploy-cli, deploy.write)
- User opens the verification page and approves
- DevicePoll() polls /token with the device_code

What to point at

- Good for CLI, TV, and limited-input devices
- Before approval: authorization_pending
- After approval: token response, then calls /api/deploy

Start from the application shape

Web / SPA / mobile with a user

Authorization Code + PKCE

Backend service, no user

Client Credentials

Renew an access token

Refresh Token

CLI / TV / limited input

Device Authorization

Need the user's identity / login

OpenID Connect

Two questions, two tokens

OAuth 2.0

- Delegated API access
- Access token
- Scopes; the resource API validates

OpenID Connect

- Login identity
- ID token
- User claims; the client validates identity

Heads-up for Session 2: this demo requests the `openid` scope, so go-oidc also issues an `id_token` — that is OpenID Connect, covered in Session 2.

Most confusion mixes tokens, actors, and endpoints

Calling OAuth “login”

Use OIDC language when identity / login is the goal.

Access token as identity

Access token is for APIs; ID token carries login claims.

Thinking /token redirects

/token returns JSON data to the client; it never redirects.

Confusing state and PKCE

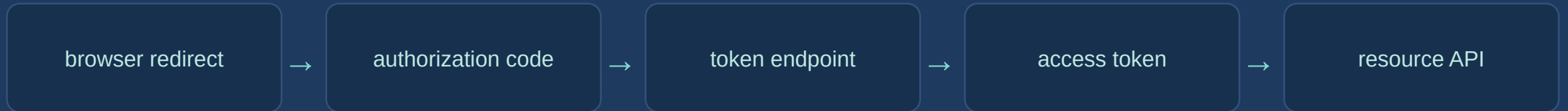
state protects the callback; PKCE protects the code exchange.

Run it in this exact order

- 1 go run . (starts :8080, :8081, :8082)
- 2 open `http://localhost:8082`
- 3 “Start Auth Code + PKCE flow” → Approve for Alya Developer
- 4 “Call resource API with current access token”
- 5 “Use refresh token”
- 6 “Run Client Credentials demo”
- 7 “Start Device Authorization demo” → open verification page → approve → poll
- 8 “Reset All Data” to run a clean pass again

SESSION 1 CHECKPOINT

Explain this chain from memory



Final task: say who sends each request, where the token appears, and which party validates it.